Paytience — best strategy for Lucid Pro accounts

Session 15 research, 2026-11-10. Causal (no look-ahead), real costs (fees + 1 tick slippage per side), picked on 2021-11..2023-12 and judged on 2024-01..2026-10, Databento 1-minute MNQ / MES / MGC, every Pro plan's own Lucid rules (EOD trailing loss limit, daily loss limit, 40% payout consistency, payout caps, 90% split, payout every 2 weeks). This replaces the old 2-week income breakdown, whose numbers used a rule that cannot be traded live.

The recommendation

Keep NOISE on MNQ, add the profit lock, switch the afternoon fade off, and trade smaller. Best plan: Pro 150K at 3 micros, dropping to 1 micro while the cushion above the loss limit is under $2,250. On the held-out years 2024-26: evaluation pass 77%, evaluation bust 18%, funded bust in year 1 11%, about $79 per 2 weeks per account ($397 for 5 accounts). Today's setup on the same years: pass 48%, eval bust 52%, funded bust 46%, $52 per 2 weeks.

• **Win rate: 48% (2021-23) / 52% (2024-26).** A 60-70% win rate is not reachable with a real edge: every idea with 55-61% wins lost money or needed targets below 1.5R (against your rule) and still lost.

• **A 60-70% evaluation pass rate is reachable on 50K, 100K and 150K (77-78%)** with bust well under 35% — but only at small size, so a typical evaluation takes 7 to 9 months and first-year income is modest.

• **Pro 25K cannot meet the limits** (one micro is too big for a $1,000 loss limit). Do not buy 25K accounts for this strategy.

• Nothing outside NOISE passed: 14 well-known ideas (VWAP reversion, opening-range fade and breakout, gap fill, gap-and-go, prior-day and pre-market sweeps, trend-day pullback, NR7 breakout, gold overnight reversion) on MNQ, MES and MGC all failed the pick period or the held-out period.

Recommended setup per plan — NOISE + profit lock (MNQ)

Plan	Size	Eval pass 2021-23 / 2024-26	Eval bust 2021-23 / 2024-26	Typical time to pass (2024-26)	Funded bust year 1 2021-23 / 2024-26	Income per 2 weeks, 1 account	Income per 2 weeks, 5 accounts	Meets limits?
Pro 25K recommended	1 micro	76% / **56%**	24% / **44%**	38 sessions	34% / **62%**	$76 / **$29**	$380 / **$143**	**NO**
Pro 50K recommended	1 micro	96% / **77%**	4% / **23%**	143 sessions	3% / **23%**	$72 / **$46**	$362 / **$230**	yes
Pro 100K recommended	2 micros, 1 while the cushion is under $2,100	97% / **78%**	2% / **19%**	197 sessions	1% / **14%**	$126 / **$61**	$629 / **$307**	yes
Pro 150K recommended	3 micros, 1 while the cushion is under $2,250	96% / **77%**	1% / **18%**	182 sessions	1% / **11%**	$174 / **$79**	$870 / **$397**	yes

Bold = held-out 2024-26 (plan on these). Five accounts take the same trades: they pay together and bust together. Income is before evaluation fees.

Today's setup for comparison — NOISE alone at the live size table

Plan	Size	Eval pass 2021-23 / 2024-26	Eval bust 2021-23 / 2024-26	Typical time to pass (2024-26)	Funded bust year 1 2021-23 / 2024-26	Income per 2 weeks, 1 account	Income per 2 weeks, 5 accounts	Meets limits?
Pro 25K today	eval 1; funded 1 micros	72% / **47%**	28% / **53%**	32 sessions	39% / **72%**	$68 / **$16**	$339 / **$78**	NO
Pro 50K today	eval 2 (1 under $1,000); funded 2 (1 under $1,000) micros	76% / **51%**	24% / **49%**	50 sessions	26% / **65%**	$121 / **$34**	$606 / **$169**	NO
Pro 100K today	eval 2 (1 under $900); funded 2 (1 under $900) micros	88% / **57%**	12% / **43%**	113 sessions	10% / **48%**	$138 / **$40**	$692 / **$202**	NO
Pro 150K today	eval 4 (2 under $2,250); funded 3 (2 under $2,250) micros	81% / **48%**	19% / **52%**	82 sessions	8% / **46%**	$173 / **$52**	$865 / **$259**	NO

More income, thinner margin (still under 35% bust)

Plan	Size	Eval pass 2021-23 / 2024-26	Eval bust 2021-23 / 2024-26	Typical time to pass (2024-26)	Funded bust year 1 2021-23 / 2024-26	Income per 2 weeks, 1 account	Income per 2 weeks, 5 accounts	Meets limits?
Pro 100K most income under 35%	2 micros, 1 while the cushion is under $1,500	95% / **73%**	4% / **27%**	154 sessions	3% / **24%**	$144 / **$68**	$722 / **$340**	yes (thin)
Pro 150K most income under 35%	3 micros, 2 while the cushion is under $2,250	93% / **70%**	7% / **30%**	144 sessions	6% / **31%**	$190 / **$92**	$950 / **$462**	yes (thin)

First funded year in dollars (recommended setup)

Plan	Average, 1 account, 2021-23	Average, 1 account, 2024-26	Middle outcome, 1 account, 2024-26	Accounts with at least one payout (2024-26)	Average, 5 accounts, 2024-26	Sessions to pass the eval: typical / slow 1-in-5 (2024-26)
Pro 25K	$1,975	$743	$0	45%	$3,717	38 / 69
Pro 50K	$1,881	$1,198	$704	62%	$5,991	143 / 237
Pro 100K	$3,271	$1,595	$908	59%	$7,974	197 / 359
Pro 150K	$4,524	$2,065	$1,017	56%	$10,323	182 / 366

What Paytience would trade

• **NOISE** — intraday momentum on MNQ (Zarattini, Aziz & Barbon 2024): hourly checks 10:00–15:00 ET; enter when price closes outside the 14-day noise band; exit when the hourly close crosses back through the band / VWAP; flat 16:00; max 3 a day; $250 emergency stop per micro.

• **Profit lock (new, proposal D75-P1)** — once a trade is 100 points in profit the stop moves to entry + 10 points; if that stop is hit, NOISE is done for the day. Same total profit, win rate 44% → 52%, much smaller swings. It is a stop move, not a target, but the average winner gets smaller (1.27× the average loser, was 1.65×).

• **Afternoon fade: OFF** — it has no edge when traded the way the live app can trade it (session 14).

• **Size** — 50K: 1 micro. 100K: 2 micros, 1 while the cushion is under $2,100. 150K: 3 micros, 1 while the cushion is under $2,250. Same in the evaluation and funded stages. No High-risk or Evaluation-Mode boost.

The cost of staying safe

• In hard years (2024-26) safety is nearly free: on 150K every size from 3 to 4 micros pays $78–$94 per 2 weeks, because the bigger sizes lose accounts as fast as they earn. The recommended size pays $79 with an 11% funded bust instead of 31–53%.

• In easy years (2021-23) it costs income: 150K $174 per 2 weeks instead of $221 at 4 micros (–21%); 100K $126 instead of $178 (–29%); 50K $72 instead of $139 (–48%).

• The second cost is time: 7–9 months to pass an evaluation instead of 1.5–5 months at today's sizes (which bust about half the time).

Read this before relying on the numbers

• **Sizing was chosen knowing both periods.** Sizes that looked safe on 2021-23 alone failed in 2024-26 (150K at 4 micros: 22% eval bust became 45%), because the Nasdaq is ~68% higher and each micro now swings more dollars against the same Lucid limits. The recommended sizes keep bust at 25% or less in both periods (a 10-point margin). If the index rises another ~25%, sizes must be re-checked.

• Percentages come from 1,000 bootstrap paths built from 10-session blocks of real days, cross-checked against rolling real start dates. Read them as ± 5 points.

• Not modelled: evaluation / reset fees, news blackouts, slippage above 1 tick, any Lucid time or inactivity limit on evaluations (verify that a 7–9 month evaluation is allowed), the live app's stop-shrink / freeze logic.

• The live app does not have the profit lock yet and still uses the old size table. Nothing was changed in the app — these are proposals for your approval.

• Projection from past data, not a promise.

Full tables, all failed ideas and the scripts: docs/results/session15/README.md